

Data Protection Education (DPE) Clarion Corvus Trust Report June 2023

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Introduction

Clarion Academy Trust and Corvus Education Trust merged in April 2023. DPE were previously working with both Trusts prior to the merger. Clarion Academy trust via a full subscription, whilst Corvus Education Trust initially via a short-term agreement, which included a 2-school audit and follow up report.

The previous Clarion Academy Trust reports were written using the headings from the ICO accountability tracker for benchmarking, information obtained from the DPE dashboard and from working with the Trust. Corvus Education Trust was provided with a report that included a comprehensive gap analysis. Because of the merger and transfer of data protection responsibilities, to allow time to support JR and standardise practice and policy documentation across the Trust, this report is intended as a summary with actions for the coming year for the merged Trust.

Summary

Leadership and oversight: The Trust's data protection lead role has moved from Mike Quantrill (MQ) to JR. SL has had meetings with both MQ and JR throughout 2022/23 and will now liaise directly with JR for activities in 2023/24. MQ will continue to support JR internally during the transition stage. SL will work with JR in amalgamating the findings from the previous Trust reports and support with an action plan that can be used going forward.

Policies and procedures: MQ had previously worked with DPE to update and implement key documentation for Clarion Academy Trust. To avoid duplication, Clarion's documentation will now be used for the previous Corvus Education Trust schools. Clarion's documents will be updated to reflect the name change (Clarion Corvus Trust). SL will review policy documentation for the Autumn term 2023 term; so that all documentation is updated and aligned for Clarion Corvus Trust.

Training and awareness: Most staff have completed data protection and cyber awareness training. This is also part of and/or will be part of the induction process for new staff. Both QM and JR are following up with staff where training is yet to be completed and if not already, the Trust will add Stay Safe Online NCSC and GDPR training as part of the induction process for new staff.

Information Security: The ICO accountability tracker was previously completed as much as possible for Clarion Academy Trust. In addition, SL has had meetings with QM, Clarion Academy Trusts IT lead and DPEs ICT specialist to look at in more detail an IT audit action plan that was subsequently rag rated. From this, Clarion Academy Trust has been able to identify any additional risks and mitigations. JR will/has also shared the action plan with Watton Westfields/Juniors IT provider and once completed, SL will work with JR and amalgamate for Clarion Corvus Trust.

The Trust continues to log SARS, FOIs and make use of the DPE website for support and resources. From log information and actions, the Trust should continue to raise awareness, reduce risks and improve practice.

Actions for 2023/24

The focus for the coming year is to support JR with compliance actions, align data protection practices and work from a standard action plan for 2023/24. Actions include:

- Policy review
- Amalgamate previous report actions/gap analysis and the ICO accountability tracker to form an action plan for 2023/24.
- Training and awareness, including any PD for JR
- Information and cyber security, including amalgamating the cyber action plan
- Risk assessments/DPIAs
- Third party suppliers and due diligence